WEDNESDAY, 4 NOVEMBER 2026

ALWAYS FREE

Inside Desk

EVENING EPAPER

PUBLISHED 17:30 CET · BERLIN

LEAD · HEALTH & CARE

264,417 visits, ten days each, and up to eight in ten diagnoses made on the ward

Heart failure hospital visits in the UK rose 52% in a decade, more than twice as fast as hospital visits overall. The striking number is not the rise. It is where the diagnosis gets made.

> UK hospital visits for heart failure hit a record 264,417 a year, and up to eight in ten diagnoses in England are made on the ward. Elsewhere: markets cheering a divided Washington, euro-area inflation at 4.0% but 2.3% without energy, Thursday's power back above €250, 310 drones at Ukraine's grid, and schools shut in Sardinia a day before the storm.

Read the lead →

Go to page 4 →

Heart failure is now found mostly in hospital beds, and the cheapest remedy for that is a doctor listening to a breathless patient's chest a few months sooner.

ALSO INSIDE · 34 PIECES

9 POLITICS & INSTITUTIONS
Podium vs Print: "I'd just veto everything" and two thirds

11 PSYCHOLOGY & BEHAVIOUR
The Annex: 7.3 million congressional messages, and why the attack gets 80% more retweets

13 MONEY, FX & COMMITTEES
4.0% on the label, 2.3% underneath: euro-area inflation is an energy bill

15 ORDINARY & INHERITED LIFE
Ordinary Ledger: €2.32 more a year for the wires, if a subsidy passes by 7 December

GEO-ECONOMICS · P. 6
51.7 and falling: the euro zone still grows, but its customers have stopped ordering

MARKETS & MACRO · P. 7
Dow up 1.93% at the open, DAX up 2.13%: markets toast a Washington that can do less

ENERGY & INDUSTRY · P. 12
€257.38: one day under €250, and Thursday is back above it

CLIMATE & WEATHER · P. 19
Red from the Sarrabus to Gallura, yellow from Hérault to Var, and schools shut a day ahead

THE DAY IN ONE SENTENCE

Heart failure is now found mostly in hospital beds, and the cheapest remedy for that is a doctor listening to a breathless patient's chest a few months sooner.

Read this edition in reading view →

In this issue

3 LATEST
Latest

4 LEAD
264,417 visits, ten days each, and up to eight in ten diagnoses made on the ward

6 GEO-ECONOMICS · 3 PIECES
51.7 and falling: the euro zone still grows, but its customers have stopped ordering

7 MARKETS & MACRO · 4 PIECES
Dow up 1.93% at the open, DAX up 2.13%: markets toast a Washington that can do less

9 POLITICS & INSTITUTIONS · 3 PIECES
Podium vs Print: "I'd just veto everything" and two thirds

11 PSYCHOLOGY & BEHAVIOUR · 3 PIECES
The Annex: 7.3 million congressional messages, and why the attack gets 80% more retweets

12 ENERGY & INDUSTRY · 3 PIECES
€257.38: one day under €250, and Thursday is back above it

13 MONEY, FX & COMMITTEES · 3 PIECES
4.0% on the label, 2.3% underneath: euro-area inflation is an energy bill

15 ORDINARY & INHERITED LIFE · 3 PIECES
Ordinary Ledger: €2.32 more a year for the wires, if a subsidy passes by 7 December

16 TECH & COMPUTE · 3 PIECES
An off button for AI agents, sold as news: CrowdStrike's kill switch and the oldest control in computing

17 HEALTH & CARE · 3 PIECES
264,417 visits, ten days each, and up to eight in ten diagnoses made on the ward

18 SECURITY & ORDER · 3 PIECES
310 drones, 272 stopped, 19 places hit, and the water came back by morning

19 CLIMATE & WEATHER · 3 PIECES
Red from the Sarrabus to Gallura, yellow from Hérault to Var, and schools shut a day ahead

20 CHARTS AND DATA
Charts and data

21 BACK PAGE
Before you close the tab

THIS ISSUE

UK hospital visits for heart failure hit a record 264,417 a year, and up to eight in ten diagnoses in England are made on the ward. Elsewhere: markets cheering a divided Washington, euro-area inflation at 4.0% but 2.3% without energy, Thursday's power back above €250, 310 drones at Ukraine's grid, and schools shut in Sardinia a day before the storm.

11 edition pieces · 11 desks · Published 17:30 CET, 4 November 2026

23 ePaper extras, added 19:27 CET, 4 November. They appear only in the ePaper and carry their own time.

The website edition

THE EPAPER RHYTHM

06:30 Morning ePaper (website edition at 08:30)

17:30 Evening ePaper, updated live until 22:30 with an “Updated” time and a Latest page

Sun 10:00 The Sunday Magazine

Berlin time. Every issue is free.

HOW TO READ IT

Swipe, use the arrow keys or the page strip. Tap any headline for the reading view. Press / to search, t for contents, + / - to zoom. Download the PDF.

Latest

Live: this page and the issue are updated until 22:30 Berlin time.

19:27 Markets: Frankfurt's settled close is in, DAX up 2.22%, banks up 4.6%, Siemens Energy down 8% Read →

HEALTH & CARE · LEAD · 4 MIN

264,417 visits, ten days each, and up to eight in ten diagnoses made on the ward

Heart failure hospital visits in the UK rose 52% in a decade, more than twice as fast as hospital visits overall. The striking number is not the rise. It is where the diagnosis gets made.

On Wednesday the British Heart Foundation opened a new data platform, its CVD Observatory, and the first figure it put on the table was a record[1]. In 2014/15, UK hospitals recorded 173,744 visits for heart failure. In 2024/25 they recorded 264,417, a rise of 52%[1]. Over the same decade, hospital visits of every kind rose by 20%[1]. England's rise was the steepest of the four nations, at 58%[1].

Desk arithmetic: that is 90,673 more visits a year than a decade ago, or about 724 a day in 2024/25. The BHF says heart failure patients stay in hospital for around ten days, about twice the average stay[1]. Desk arithmetic again, and only roughly, since "around ten days" is an average: 264,417 visits at ten days each comes to about 2.6 million bed days a year, and the decade's growth alone adds roughly 900,000.

It would be easy to read this as a story about hearts getting worse. Read the charity's own explanation first. The rise, it says, reflects an ageing and growing population, "more people surviving heart attacks", and stark health inequalities[1]. The middle item matters. A country that saves more people from heart attacks will have more people living with damaged hearts afterwards. Some of this line is the bill for a success, and you should not want it gone at the price of the success.

The number that is not in the headline. Further down the release is the figure that changes the argument. Research suggests that up to 80% of heart failure diagnoses in England are made in hospital, even though 40% of those patients had symptoms that should have triggered an earlier diagnosis[1]. That is the real story. The condition affects more than a million people in the UK[1]. Most of them are not found at a desk with a stethoscope and a referral form. They are found on a ward, already breathless and swollen.

The BHF's chief scientific and medical officer, Professor Bryan Williams, put it plainly: "Most hospital visits for heart failure could be prevented"[1]. Too often, he told the Mirror, someone is only diagnosed "when they are already seriously unwell"[2].

INSIDE DESK · HEALTH

Heart failure is filling beds faster than everything else

Rise in hospital visits between 2014/15 and 2024/25, %



▶ Data table

Source: British Heart Foundation, CVD Observatory analysis, published 4 Nov 2026; retrieved 4 Nov 2026 · CSV

The patient story the charity published is a case study in how that happens, not in negligence. Szandra Tar, 35, from Grangemouth, was fit and played volleyball[1]. Her symptoms began with shoulder aches at the end of 2024. By early 2025 she was out of breath after a short walk. A GP call in June 2025 ended with over-exercising or anxiety as the explanation[1]. By July she could not climb a flight of stairs, her face had swollen, and the swelling was put down to the heat or antibiotics[1]. …

Whole piece in reading view →

WHAT TO WATCH

- How the BHF's new CVD Observatory breaks the figures down by region and inequality as it adds data; the charity calls it a platform that 'will grow'.
- England's Cardiovascular Disease Modern Service Framework, which the health department says is meant to find and treat people earlier.

DESK COMMENT

A bed is the most expensive place to learn a name you could have heard in a surgery.

GEO-ECONOMICS · 2 MIN

51.7 and falling: the euro zone still grows, but its customers have stopped ordering

October's final purchasing managers' survey came in below the flash. The headline is still growth; the order book is the line to read.

The euro zone's economy grew again in October, but more slowly than anyone had pencilled in. S&P Global's final composite purchasing managers' index came in at 51.7, down from 53.1 in September and below the flash estimate of 51.9[1]. It is a four-month low. Anything above 50 means activity is still rising, so this is a slowdown, not a fall. The services index, the bigger part of the economy, slipped to 51.4 from 53.0[1].

The headline hides the line that matters. New orders "grew only marginally", Reuters reports, after three months of stronger growth, and demand for services edged lower[1]. Export orders rose for a third month but lost pace[1]. Employment fell marginally, with services firms cutting and factories adding a few people[1]. Business confidence weakened for a third month in a row and stayed below its long-run average[1].

The reason is printed on the invoices. Input-price inflation rose to a five-month high, and firms raised their own prices sharply, though slightly less than in September[1]. Chris Williamson, chief business economist at S&P Global Market Intelligence, linked it "largely" to higher energy prices, "which are squeezing customers' budgets and discouraging spending"[1]. That is the war in the Gulf arriving on European invoices: the Strait of Hormuz, which usually carries a fifth of the world's oil and gas shipments, was effectively closed after the war began in February, and a preliminary deal in June to reopen it collapsed within weeks; ships are still being hit[2].

By country, France slipped back into contraction after a brief recovery in September; Germany, Italy, Spain and Ireland still grew, though all lost momentum[1]. …

Continue in reading view →

WHAT TO WATCH

- The ECB's December meeting: economists polled by Reuters last month expect a rate rise.
- Whether input prices keep climbing in November's survey, after a five-month high in October.

DESK COMMENT

Growth is what you sold last month. Orders are what you will be allowed to sell next.

GEO-ECONOMICS · SHORT ITEM · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

45, 77, 126, 240: Iran's Hormuz blacklist reaches the box ships

Iran's list of 'non-compliant' vessels doubled on Monday. The new risk sits less in the strait than in the paperwork of every Gulf booking.

On Monday Iran's Persian Gulf Strait Authority added 114 vessels to its "non-compliant" list, bringing it to 240, The Maritime Executive reported, as summarised by Forwarder News[1]. The list started at 45 ships in late August and stood at 77 by mid-September[1]. Iran says listed ships face "fines, detention, or confiscation" unless they clear passage with it and use the northern channel near its coast[1].

The risk firm Orbital counts 118 crude tankers among the 240, plus LPG and LNG carriers, a few bulk carriers and now four containerships[1]. Seventy-two entries are linked to Gulf state companies such as ADNOC, Nakilat, QatarEnergy and Bahri[1]. The new clause that matters most: any vessel that cooperates with a listed ship, "via STS, transshipment, etc.", will itself be added[1].

Continue in reading view →

GEO-ECONOMICS · BRIEF · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

€70 billion short for 2027, and the Bundestag votes on the 27th

The European Commission hosted Ukraine, the US, France, Germany, the UK, NATO and the World Bank in Brussels on Wednesday, with post-war reconstruction and "prosperity" on the agenda[2]. The figure behind the word: Ukraine faces a €70 billion hole in its 2027 finances, with just €4 billion pledged from outside the EU, bne IntelliNews reports[1]. Germany's draft 2027 budget carries €11.6 billion for Ukraine, falling to €8.5 billion a year for 2028–2030 under the cabinet's April plan[1]. The Bundestag's budget committee holds its final session on 12 November and the final vote is on 27 November[1]. NATO allies were also €13 billion short of the €70 billion in military aid agreed for 2026, according to the Commission[1]. Prosperity plans are drafted in meeting rooms; they are paid for in budget committees, line by line.

MARKETS & MACRO · 2 MIN

Dow up 1.93% at the open, DAX up 2.13%: markets toast a Washington that can do less

Investors did not cheer a party; they cheered a divided government, and then sold the shares that needed one side to win.

The morning's question was who won. By the afternoon, markets had answered a different one: how much can the winners actually do? The Dow Jones Industrial Average opened 997.76 points, or 1.93%, higher at 52,784.48 on Wednesday, the S&P 500 1.14% higher at 7,655.43 and the Nasdaq Composite 1.07% higher at 25,643.36[1]. Reuters put the mood plainly: investors were betting that "a divided Washington" after the Democrats' sweep of Congress could limit sharp policy shifts[1].

Frankfurt had already started. At 15:41 CET the DAX was 2.13% higher at 26,416.42 points, after opening at 25,888.93 and touching a low of 25,876.82[2]. Since Monday the index is up 2.38%, and since January 7.65%[2]. The day's best performers were not election trades at all: Heidelberg Materials was up 9.96% and Continental 5.98%, both on quarterly figures, with Commerzbank up 5.95%[2]. At the bottom sat Siemens Energy, down 4.22% at €124.30[2].

Inside the rally, a sorting. Before New York opened, the shares that had needed one side to win were already moving. Data-centre operators slipped on the prospect of tougher congressional oversight of the AI build-out; defence names such as Northrop Grumman fell 5% on doubts that a $1.5 trillion budget request will pass untouched; prison operators GEO Group and CoreCivic lost 6.7% and 5.2%[3]. Solar and wind companies rose, and hospital operators and health insurers gained[3]. …

Continue in reading view →

MARKETS & MACRO · SHORT ITEM · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

$1.61 as expected, the year cut and the CFO leaving: why FIS fell on a rising day

A quarter that matched the forecast was not the news. The lower full-year guidance and the empty finance chair were.

On a morning when most of Wall Street went up, one payments processor went sharply the other way. Fidelity National Information Services, the bank-software and payments group known as FIS, fell 17.2% in pre-market trading to $32.30, close to its 52-week low of $32.09[2]. Its 52-week high was $68.37[2].

The quarter itself was ordinary. Adjusted earnings of $1.61 a share matched the consensus of $1.60, and revenue of about $3.43 billion was in line with forecasts[2]. The trouble sat in the two lines below it.

The year got smaller. FIS now expects adjusted earnings of $5.82 to $5.89 a share for 2026, down from $6.15 to $6.24, and revenue of $13.445 to $13.505 billion, down from $13.630 to $13.695 billion[1]. Desk arithmetic: at the midpoints that is about 5.5% off earnings and 1.4% off revenue. Pro forma revenue growth is now put at 3.1% to 3.6%, from 4.5% to 5.0%[1].

The finance chair empties tomorrow. Chief financial officer James Kehoe steps down on 5 November and stays as a non-executive adviser until March 2027; chief accounting officer Alexandra Brooks becomes interim CFO[1]. The company also said meaningful share buybacks will resume only once gross leverage falls to about 2.8 times[1].

Investing.com notes that analysts had already made 21 downward earnings revisions in the 90 days before the report[2]. Expectations had been lowered, and the shares still fell. That is the quiet lesson: a forecast you meet is only half the story if the next one you write is lower. Read the guidance before the headline. Nothing here is investment advice.

WHAT TO WATCH

- The Xetra close at 17:30 CET: at 15:41 the DAX stood at 26,416.42, against a 2026 high of 26,618.74. Desk arithmetic: about 202 points short.
- Whether the gap between winners and losers inside the S&P 500 survives the first full session.

DESK COMMENT

Markets rarely applaud what a government will do. They applaud what it now cannot.

MARKETS & MACRO · SHORT ITEM · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 19:27 CET

DAX closes up 2.22%, banks up 4.6%, and Siemens Energy down 8%

This evening's Markets note was written at 15:41. The settled close is a little higher, and the sorting inside it is sharper.

The evening's Markets note left the DAX at 15:41, up 2.13%. Xetra has since closed it 2.22% higher at 26,437.67 points[1]. At its best the index stood near 26,542, only 78 points short of its record from late August, and the MDax closed 1.41% higher at 31,178.27[1]. The Stoxx Europe 600 ended 1.82% higher at 657.40, its highest since 26 August and its steepest one-day gain since 12 June[2].

The sorting the afternoon hinted at held to the bell. Euro Stoxx banks rose 4.6%, the most since early April; Morningstar's Michael Field said a Democratic Congress limits Washington's ability to impose "requirements or sanctions" on European banks in the US[2]. Orsted gained 4.6% and Nordex 4.8%[2]. On the other side, Siemens Energy shed 8% and Infineon, ASML and Soitec fell between 3.4% and 11.8%, on the prospect of stricter oversight of AI[2]. Heidelberg Materials closed 9.6% higher on its quarter, and Novo Nordisk 5.6% on a raised forecast[2]. Brent fell 8%, and oil shares with it[2].

Dekabank's Joachim Schallmayer read the vote as a signal that Trump's policy is "nicht grenzenlos durchsetzbar", not limitlessly enforceable, though he expects no dramatic change of course[1]. A close near a record is a mood; the invoices arrive later. Nothing here is investment advice.

MARKETS & MACRO · BRIEF · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

Cement up 10%: Heidelberg Materials sells the dullest product in the DAX, and topped it

Heidelberg Materials was the best performer in the DAX on Wednesday afternoon, up 9.96% at €172.15 at 15:41 CET[2]. The reason was a quarter without fireworks. Third-quarter revenue rose 10% to €6,413 million and the result from current operations 9% to €1,281 million, driven, the company says, by Europe, North America and "uncompromising" cost and price management[1].

The full-year range of €3.40 to €3.65 billion was confirmed, not raised[1]. What was new is housekeeping: the cost programme will beat its €500 million target this year, and a further €300 million of savings is planned, in nearly equal parts in 2027 and 2028[1]. Cement, quarries and asphalt plants rarely make headlines. On a day of election trades, they made the top of the table. Nothing here is investment advice.

POLITICS & INSTITUTIONS · PODIUM VS PRINT · 2 MIN

Podium vs Print: "I'd just veto everything" and two thirds

The president told Democrats they will want to work with him or face his veto. The Constitution prints the number that decides who needs whom, and it cuts both ways.

PODIUM

“going to want to work with me. Otherwise I'd just veto everything and they're not going to want that”

Donald Trump, president of the United States, in an interview with CBS News, Wednesday 4 November 2026, the morning after the midterm elections

PRINT

two thirds

A vetoed bill becomes law only "if approved by two thirds" of each House.

US Constitution, Article I, Section 7, In force since 1789

The podium. The morning after his party lost both chambers, Donald Trump told CBS News that Democrats are “going to want to work with me. Otherwise I’d just veto everything and they’re not going to want that”[1]. Separately he told Fox News that “a part of it was Iran”, meaning the war and the petrol prices that followed it[4]. The veto line is the one to check, because it rests on a number.

The print. The Constitution prints that number. A bill the president returns unsigned becomes law only if, after reconsideration, it is “approved by two thirds” of each House[2]. CBS News projects at least 54 Democratic senators in January, with Alaska and Mississippi still uncalled[1]. In the House, Democrats had a 228–139 majority on Wednesday morning, with 68 races still uncalled[3]. Desk arithmetic: with all 100 senators voting, an override needs 67, so Democrats would need 13 Republican votes; with all 435 House seats filled and voting, it needs 290, which is 62 more than the 228 Democratic seats called so far.

The gap. On the arithmetic, the podium is right: a 54-seat Senate cannot override a veto alone. But the same article of the Constitution also prints the other half of the bargain. “No Money shall be drawn from the Treasury, but in Consequence of Appropriations made by Law,” it says in Section 9[2]. Spending laws start in Congress, and from January Congress means Democrats. A president who vetoes everything also vetoes the budgets his own departments run on. The veto stops things; it does not pay anybody.

What it means for you. Both sides now hold a brake, and neither holds the whole steering wheel. That is not gridlock by design so much as the machinery asking for signatures from two places at once. The useful thing to watch is not the next speech but the first appropriations bill: who drafts it, how many Republicans vote for it, and whether it comes back signed. Speeches say “everything”. Bills come one at a time, with page numbers.

POLITICS & INSTITUTIONS · SHORT ITEM · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

10 November, 3 January: the leadership calendar after the wave

Speaker Johnson will not run to lead House Republicans again. The next dates are internal votes, which is how power changes hands when it changes quietly.

Mike Johnson told his staff on a call on Wednesday morning that he will not run to lead House Republicans in the next Congress, according to four sources on the call quoted by NBC News[1]. He has served two terms as speaker since Kevin McCarthy was ousted in 2023[1]. Republicans hold their internal election for minority leader next week, on 10 November[1].

On the other side of the aisle, Hakeem Jeffries is expected to become the first Black speaker of the House when the new Congress convenes on 3 January[2]. Democrats had a 228–139 majority on Wednesday morning, with 68 races still uncalled[2]. “This is not a partisan moment. This is a patriotic one,” Jeffries told supporters[2].

In the Senate, John Thune, the outgoing majority leader, wrote that Republicans “will not stand idly by” and that “thankfully, we still have President Trump in the White House”[3]. Chuck Schumer, who will lead the new majority, offered Americans five words: “Relief is on the way”[3].

Those are the speeches. The dates are more useful: a caucus vote on 10 November, a swearing-in on 3 January, and then committee chairs, budgets and staff. A change of majority is mostly paperwork: who holds the gavel, who signs the subpoenas, who sets the agenda for each morning’s sitting. That is less exciting than election night, and it is the part that lasts two years.

WHAT TO WATCH

- The Senate races in Alaska and Mississippi, which CBS News still rated toss-ups on Wednesday morning.
- The new Congress, which convenes on 3 January; the first spending bill that reaches the president's desk will test the podium line.

DESK COMMENT

A veto is a brake, not an engine. Nobody drives far on brakes alone.

POLITICS & INSTITUTIONS · BRIEF · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

Two Senate seats still counting, and one lawsuit already dismissed

Control of the Senate is settled, but two seats are not. CBS News still rated Alaska and Mississippi as toss-ups on Wednesday morning[1]. In Alaska, Republican Senator Dan Sullivan and Democrat Mary Peltola are in a tight race that CBS says could take some time to count[1]. It was shaken up by allegations that operatives linked to Peltola recruited a second candidate also called Dan Sullivan; her team denied it[1]. The Trump administration had sued to block certification if the incumbent got fewer votes than Peltola, and a federal judge dismissed that suit on Sunday[1]. In Mississippi, Senator Cindy Hyde-Smith and Democrat Scott Colom are in what CBS calls an “unexpectedly close” race[1]. Neither result changes who runs the chamber. Both will tell you something about whether the slow, dull count is still trusted to finish the job.

PSYCHOLOGY & BEHAVIOUR · 2 MIN

The Annex: 7.3 million congressional messages, and why the attack gets 80% more retweets

A study of fourteen years of posts and newsletters from US lawmakers finds attacks on the other party paid off online, while bipartisan work and help for constituents did worse than average. The authors call it a mirage.

The document. "Measuring Partisanship and Representation in Online Congressional Communications", by Michael Kistner of the University of Houston and five co-authors, in the *American Political Science Review*[1]. It covers members of the US Congress from 2009 to 2022: about 4.7 million posts on Twitter, 2.4 million on Facebook and 184,000 official email newsletters[1]. Desk arithmetic: roughly 7.3 million messages in all. On the day after a midterm, it is worth reading what the campaign looked like when nobody was campaigning.

The line. On Twitter, negative partisan attacks received 60% more likes, 80% more retweets and 79% more replies than an average post by the same politician[1]. On Facebook, they drew 86% more shares and 93% more comments[1]. Messages about bipartisan work or services for the local district did worse than the typical post, and so did claiming credit for something government had delivered[1].

The lines around it. Attacks made up about five to ten per cent of messages in the early years and nearly twenty per cent by the end of 2022[1]. Language-based partisanship rose across all three channels from 2011[1]. Measured this way, Democratic rhetoric showed no statistically significant trend over the decade, while Republican rhetoric moved strongly towards the extremes[1]. The sharpest rise in Democratic attack messages came after the 2016 election; the Republican spike followed 2020[1]. Messages about funding for the district or helping constituents did not keep pace[1].

The caveats. The data stop in 2022, before the rise of newer, more partisan platforms[1]. Messages were classified by language models trained on a hand-coded subset; the authors checked the scores against roll-call votes, fundraising and bill sponsorship, and they lined up well[1]. Engagement measures what a polarised online audience rewards, not what the electorate wants.

Continue in reading view →

WHAT TO WATCH

- Whether follow-up work extends the data past 2022 to Bluesky, Truth Social, YouTube and Instagram; the authors say it has not yet been done.

DESK COMMENT

Applause is a measure of the room, not of the town.

PSYCHOLOGY & BEHAVIOUR · SHORT ITEM · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

Not 'men' and 'women' but how masculine or feminine you feel: three US surveys, and a gender gap that splits inside each sex

Two political scientists asked people to rate themselves on both scales. Binary sex stopped predicting political participation once they did.

Election nights are narrated in blocs: how men voted, how women voted. A paper by Claire Gothreau of Lebanon Valley College and Amanda Friesen of the University of Western Ontario, in *Politics and the Life Sciences*, suggests that the bloc hides most of the story[1]. They asked people to rate, on separate continuous scales, how masculine and how feminine they feel[1].

Continue in reading view →

PSYCHOLOGY & BEHAVIOUR · BRIEF · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

'Feel' or 'reporter': one word changed how autistic teenagers' brains handled scratchy wool

Researchers at UCLA and the University of Washington scanned 47 autistic and 45 non-autistic young people aged 8 to 15 while artificial grass and scratchy wool were rubbed on their forearm[1]. Before some blocks the screen said "feel"; before others it said "reporter", the cue to describe the texture objectively[1]. In the reporter blocks, autistic youth showed less activity in areas that register touch and in the insula, and even in the auditory cortex[1]. Their own ratings of how bad it felt did not change significantly[1].

It was one short training session in an MRI scanner, and the task was hard for younger children[1]. "This type of emotion regulation strategy could be incorporated into interventions and tested," said senior author Shulamite Green[1]. A small, testable tool, described without hype: that is how help usually arrives.

ENERGY & INDUSTRY · 2 MIN

€257.38: one day under €250, and Thursday is back above it

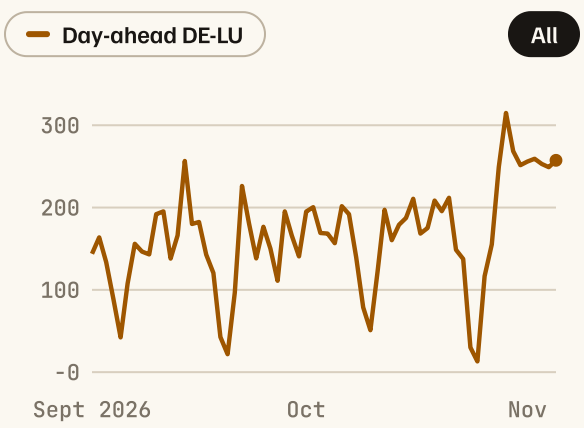
Wednesday's dip lasted exactly one delivery day; Thursday's auction puts the dear hours back where they hurt, at teatime.

This morning's relief lasted one delivery day. Today's day-ahead auction set an average of €257.38 per megawatt hour for Germany and Luxembourg for delivery on Thursday 5 November, the desk's average of the 24 hourly results SMARD published this afternoon[1]. That is €8.39 above Wednesday's €248.99, which had been the first day under €250 since 28 October[1].

ENERGY · POWER

One day under €250, then Thursday clears €257.38

Germany/Luxembourg day-ahead electricity price, daily average by delivery day, € per MWh



▶ Data table (latest values)

Source: Bundesnetzagentur | SMARD.de, day-ahead price DE-LU (filter 4169), delivery days 1 Sep to 5 Nov 2026, retrieved 4 Nov 2026 · CC BY 4.0 · CSV

The shape matters more than the average. Thursday's night is cheaper than Wednesday's: the hour from midnight cleared €196.97, the lowest single hour since Wednesday 28 October[1]. The evening is dearer: €349.36 for the 17:00 hour and €346.14 for 18:00, the highest hourly prices since Thursday 29 October[1]. …

Continue in reading view →

WHAT TO WATCH

- Thursday's evening hours: the auction cleared €349.36 for 17:00 and €346.14 for 18:00.
- SMARD's provisional full-day generation for Wednesday, which appears on Thursday morning.

DESK COMMENT

A streak that breaks for one day has not broken. It has paused for breath.

ENERGY & INDUSTRY · SHORT ITEM · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

0.9 million barrels, not 5.3: the official count shrinks the crude draw, and diesel drops under 100 million

The industry's estimate promised a big fall in US crude stocks. Wednesday's government figures found a small one, and the real squeeze in the middle distillates.

The American Petroleum Institute's figures, cited by market sources on Wednesday, showed US crude stocks falling by 5.27 million barrels in the week to 30 October; eight analysts polled by Reuters had expected a rise of about 880,000[2]. The government's own count arrived at 16:30 CET today. The US Energy Information Administration put the fall in commercial crude stocks at 865,000 barrels, to 409.8 million[1].

That is still a draw, and still the opposite of the forecast. …

Continue in reading view →

ENERGY & INDUSTRY · BRIEF · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

Vistra down 10%, Nordex up 6.5%: the power trade changes sides overnight

Texas power producer Vistra fell 10% on Wednesday morning after Democrats won Congress and Gina Hinojosa won the Texas governor's race on a promise to halt new data centres; Constellation Energy lost 6% and GE Vernova 9%[1]. In Europe the wind went the other way: Nordex rose 6.5%, Vestas 3.6% and SMA Solar 7.8%[2].

The ledgers moved less than the prices. Vistra had hedged about 94% of its expected 2027 generation as of 3 August, and reports on Thursday[1]. GE Vernova's third-quarter orders rose 96% organically[1]. Turbines and contracts take years; share prices took one morning. Nothing here is investment advice.

MONEY, FX & COMMITTEES · 2 MIN

4.0% on the label, 2.3% underneath: euro-area inflation is an energy bill

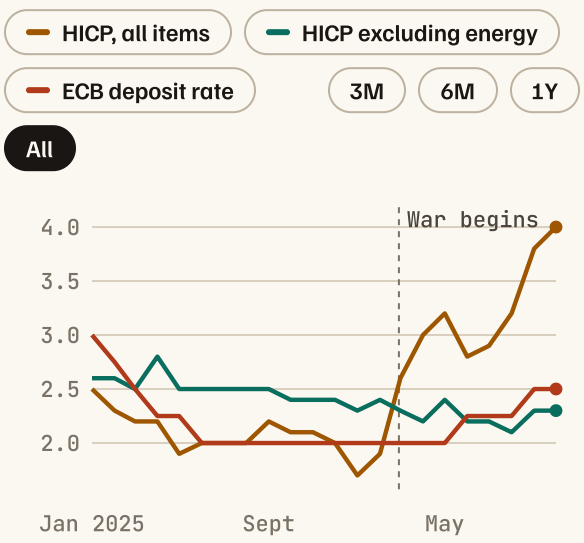
Prices across the euro area rose at their fastest pace in three years in October. Strip out energy and the rate has not moved since September.

Euro-area inflation reached 4.0% in October, up from 3.8% in September, according to Eurostat's flash estimate published this morning[1]. It is the first time the rate has hit 4% since September 2023, when it stood at 4.3%[2]. The figure was in line with what economists polled by Reuters had expected[2].

MONEY · EURO AREA

4.0% for everything, still 2.3% without energy

Euro-area HICP inflation, annual change, %, monthly: all items and all items excluding energy · ECB deposit facility rate, %, month-end



▶ Data table (latest values)

Source: Eurostat prc_hicp_minr, EA, annual rate of change, all items (TOTAL) and excluding energy (TOT_X_NRG); October 2026 from the flash estimate of 4 Nov 2026 (estimated) (CC BY 4.0) · ECB, key ECB interest rates, deposit facility, month-end, unchanged on 29 Oct 2026 · retrieved 4 Nov 2026 · CSV

One line did nearly all the climbing. Energy prices were 20.8% higher than a year earlier, up from 18.9% in September; a year ago, in October 2025, they were 0.9% lower[1]. Everything else barely moved. …

Continue in reading view →

MONEY, FX & COMMITTEES · SHORT ITEM · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

$125 billion, unchanged: the morning after an election, the US Treasury kept its sizes

While markets argued about what a new Congress might spend, the department that borrows the money published a table in which almost nothing moved.

The US Treasury will sell $125 billion of notes and bonds next week to refund about $97 billion maturing on 15 November, raising about $28 billion of new cash from private investors[1]. The pieces are a $58 billion 3-year note on Monday 9 November, a $42 billion 10-year note on Tuesday 10 November and a $25 billion 30-year bond on Thursday 12 November, each auctioned at 13:00 New York time, 19:00 CET[1].

The headline is the absence of one. Treasury said it expects to keep nominal coupon and floating-rate auction sizes unchanged "for the next several quarters"[1]. Its table for November to January shows the same monthly sizes as August to October: $69 billion of 2-year notes, $70 billion of 5-year and $44 billion of 7-year[1]. TIPS sizes are held too[1].

The changes are in the plumbing. From March 2027 the 7-year note becomes a quarterly new issue with two reopenings, like the 10-year[1]. Treasury plans buybacks of up to $70 billion of older securities for liquidity support and up to $25 billion for cash management this quarter[1]. It assumes an $850 billion cash balance at the end of December, but says the account could peak at $1.025 trillion, plus or minus $50 billion, in late November and late January[1].

Bond markets, meanwhile, were reading the election. The 10-year yield slipped more than a basis point to 4.933% on Wednesday; JPMorgan's traders said Wall Street is focusing on "reduced deficit spending" after the midterms[2]. That may or may not arrive. What has arrived is a borrowing calendar with dates and amounts, and the next one is due on 3 February 2027[1]. Nothing here is investment advice.

WHAT TO WATCH

- 18 November: Eurostat publishes the full October figures, which can revise today's flash estimate.
- The ECB's final meeting of the year in December: markets priced a hike at more than 72% after today's data.

DESK COMMENT

An average is a sentence. The breakdown is the paragraph you actually live in.

MONEY, FX & COMMITTEES · BRIEF · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

A one-month low for the dollar, and a pound that walks into Thursday strong

The dollar index fell to a one-month low on Wednesday and was last at 101.47; the pound rose 0.5% to $1.3471[1]. By late morning the euro had climbed more than 0.6% towards $1.1260–1.1280, the top of its four-week range, helped by this morning's 4.0% euro-area inflation figure[2]. Convera's George Vessey said investors increasingly see the election as "a constraint on future policy rather than a fundamental challenge" to US growth[1].

Sterling's next test is domestic. Ebury's Matthew Ryan expects a quarter-point Bank of England rise on Thursday on a 7–2 vote, and calls swap pricing of four rises within twelve months "far too excessive"[3]. A 6–3 split, he writes, would be the pound's bearish risk[3]. Nothing here is investment advice.

ORDINARY & INHERITED LIFE · 2 MIN

Ordinary Ledger: €2.32 more a year for the wires, if a subsidy passes by 7 December

Almost every grid operator in Germany has now posted its provisional fees for 2027. For a typical household the bill for the wires barely moves, and the reason it barely moves still needs a vote.

Your electricity bill has a part nobody advertises: the fee for the wires. It is set not by your supplier but by the local grid operator, and this autumn those operators have been publishing their provisional numbers for 2027. The data firm ene't, which collects them, said on Wednesday that it now has fees from 751 electricity grid operators covering 99.97% of the country[1]. That makes it the first nearly complete picture of what the wires will cost you next year.

The ledger. - Household using 4,000 kWh a year: grid costs €357.24 in 2026, €359.56 provisional for 2027, up 0.65%[1]. - Household using 1,500 kWh: €191.96 to €193.85, up 0.99%[1]. - Gas household using 7,000 kWh: €238.63 to €244.08, up 2.28%[1]. - Gas household using 20,000 kWh: €542.21 to €555.66, up 2.48%[1]. - Desk arithmetic: that is €2.32 more a year for the larger electricity household, €1.89 for the smaller one, and €5.45 and €13.45 for the two gas households. These are national averages; your own operator may sit well above or below them.

The line that holds it up. At the top of the system, the four transmission operators say their average fee will rise from 2.86 to 3.54 cents per kWh in 2027[2]. That figure already assumes a federal subsidy of €5.525 billion from the climate and transformation fund, which the cabinet approved in early September and which is about €1 billion smaller than this year's[2]. Without it, they say, the fee would rise to 6.52 cents[2]. The law is not yet passed. If there is no legal certainty by 7 December, the operators expect the final transmission fees to go up accordingly[2].

What it means for you. Nothing changes on your bill this week, and the grid is only one line on it. Two dull things are worth doing. First, keep the letter your supplier sends before January and look for the "Netzentgelt" line rather than the headline price. Second, compare that line with this year's: a switch decided on the actual numbers beats one decided on a headline.

The constructive point is that a nearly flat grid bill is not luck. It is a subsidy, a regulator and a few hundred operators filing tables on time. Nothing here is investment advice.

WHAT TO WATCH

- 7 December 2026: if the law for the €5.525 billion transmission subsidy is not legally secure by then, the operators expect the final 2027 transmission fees to rise accordingly.
- Your supplier's price letter for January, which is where any change in grid fees actually reaches you.

DESK COMMENT

The cheapest kilowatt-hour is the one whose wires someone else already agreed to pay for.

ORDINARY & INHERITED LIFE · SHORT ITEM · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

Gas 3.2% cheaper, heating oil 54.8% dearer: one state's heating bill, split by what is in the cellar

Saxony-Anhalt's statistics office marked the start of the heating season with a reminder that 'energy prices' is not one number.

Ask whether heating has got dearer and the honest answer is: it depends what you burn. Saxony-Anhalt's statistics office published its October figures for household energy on Wednesday, to mark the start of the heating season[1].

Taken together, electricity, gas and other fuels cost 0.8% more than in September and 3.6% more than in October 2025, putting the index at 151.6[1]. Underneath that average, the picture splits. …

Continue in reading view →

ORDINARY & INHERITED LIFE · BRIEF · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

€635 or €2,822 for the same good cover: what Stiftung Warentest found in 183 house policies

Stiftung Warentest has compared 183 buildings insurance tariffs from 69 providers, all including "Elementarschutz", the add-on for floods, backflow and other natural hazards[1]. Premiums rose 4.2% in 2026 from building costs and wages alone, the testers say, and the spread is wide: for their model house in Bremen, very good cover starts at €695 a year, while another very good tariff costs €2,822[1]. In Regensburg, very good cover starts at €635[1].

56 of the 183 tariffs were rated poor; weak tariffs, the testers say, do not cover damage caused by gross negligence, or not adequately[1]. Flood cover is still missing on nearly half of all residential buildings, especially in old contracts[1]. If you own a house, the dull task this week is to find your policy and check for that one word.

TECH & COMPUTE · 2 MIN

An off button for AI agents, sold as news: CrowdStrike's kill switch and the oldest control in computing

The security firm says a human can now stop a misbehaving agent, keep it from relaunching and cut its network access. That this is a product launch says a lot about how agents were being deployed.

"Everyone is building AI agents, but they never had the off button, and now they do," CrowdStrike's chief executive George Kurtz told CNBC on Tuesday[2]. Read that sentence twice. It is meant as a sales line. It is also a confession on behalf of an industry: software that acts on its own, with system-level access, has been going into companies without a dependable way to halt it.

What was launched. The "AI Kill Switch" sits in CrowdStrike's Falcon Guardian product, announced at its Fal.Con Europe conference in Barcelona and available immediately[1,2]. If an agent breaks out of its intended behaviour, an authorised administrator can terminate it, block it from launching again on a host or group of hosts, and cut off its enterprise network access[1]. Every action is recorded in an audit trail[1]. The company's own fine print matters: termination works first at the gateway, and only "soon" on the endpoint itself[1].

Why it is needed at all. The press release explains the problem plainly. Agents "chain steps, hit obstacles, and can take actions no one authorized, even when no adversary is involved"[1]. That last clause is the important one. The risk being sold against is not only the hacker; it is the helper that misreads its instructions. Kurtz compares the switch to an airbag: a safeguard you need even when the system is designed to work[2].

The contrarian reading. Strip away the launch language and what is on offer is the most traditional control in IT: a named person, a stop command, a block on restarts and a log. That is the right answer, and it is a dull one. Kurtz says enterprise customers told Anthropic, "We need CrowdStrike before we can deploy AI"[2]. Whatever the vendor, the demand is healthy: buyers asking for brakes before they buy the engine.

For you. If your employer is rolling out agents, the useful questions are the boring ones. Who can stop this agent? …

Continue in reading view →

WHAT TO WATCH

- When the termination step moves from the gateway to the endpoint; CrowdStrike says that is coming 'soon'.
- Whether rival security vendors and the AI labs themselves ship comparable, logged stop controls, so that an off switch becomes a standard rather than a feature.

DESK COMMENT

Every machine worth trusting comes with a way to stop it, and a record of who pressed it.

TECH & COMPUTE · SHORT ITEM · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

One text message that ends your call, and a patch date to look up in Settings

Google's November Android bulletin fixes a critical flaw that needs no tap from you. The fix exists; whether it reaches your phone depends on the maker.

Google's November security bulletin for Android includes a critical flaw, CVE-2026-58868, that could let an attacker run code on a phone remotely without any action by its owner[1]. It affects Android 14 to 17[1]. As of Wednesday, Google reported no attacks exploiting the flaws in the bulletin, and none was in the US cyber agency CISA's catalogue of exploited vulnerabilities[1].

Continue in reading view →

TECH & COMPUTE · BRIEF · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

Fixed on 7 August, drained on 1 November: the cost of the update nobody installed

BTCPay Server, open-source software merchants use to accept Bitcoin, says attackers stole Bitcoin and Litecoin from hot wallets on servers running version 2.4.1 or earlier[1]. The attackers used a different method to exploit a vulnerability fixed in 2.4.2, released on 7 August[1]. Servers already on 2.4.2 or later when the project warned on 1 November showed no impact[1].

"We wish we had done more to reach users still running older versions," the project writes; it also asked hosting providers to take instances offline[1]. Its advice is sober: updating alone cannot remove access an attacker may already have, so affected operators should sweep funds to a new wallet with a new seed and rebuild on a fresh server[1]. Funds whose keys sat off the server, including hardware wallets, were unaffected[1]. The patch was the cheap part. Installing it was the control.

This desk's lead is on page 4: 264,417 visits, ten days each, and up to eight in ten diagnoses made on the ward.

HEALTH & CARE · SHORT ITEM · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

One in four skipped the yearly training, and only 60% wore the right gloves

A survey of more than 1,000 German cancer-ward nurses finds the rules on chemotherapy drugs are clear. Following them is the part that slips.

The drugs that kill cancer cells do not ask whose cells they touch. A nationwide survey of more than 1,000 nurses in German oncology wards and specialist practices, published in the journal *Pflegewissenschaft*, finds that the people handing those drugs out are often less protected than the rules require[1].

About a quarter had not done any of the mandatory yearly refresher courses on handling cytostatics, which can cause cancer, mutations and harm to fertility[1]. More than 40% said they did not know their own workplace's safety guidelines, and only about 60% used the special gloves meant for these drugs[1]. In none of the clinics where respondents worked were all recommended measures fully in place[1].

Many reported skin contact during infusions, because closed transfer systems were not used enough or infusion sets were faulty; wipe tests to detect contamination were often missing[1]. Several nurses described rashes, headaches, dizziness, hair loss and changes in taste after shifts, symptoms that can point to exposure[1].

The researchers are not asking for new science. They want stricter legal duties for clinics and practices, proper equipment, regular training and consistent use of TRGS 525, Germany's existing technical rule for hazardous substances in healthcare[1]. That is the dull part, and it works: a rule only protects the hands that actually wear the glove.

HEALTH & CARE · BRIEF · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

Up to half the link, written in the blood

Researchers at UCL and Imperial College London measured 233 blood metabolites in more than 6,000 British civil servants from the Whitehall II study, then followed their health for up to 20 years[1]. An ultra-processed diet left a recognisable pattern: less omega-3 and "good" HDL cholesterol, more of the triglycerides that clog arteries[1].

That pattern accounted for 51% of the diet's link with later cardiovascular disease and 43% of its link with type 2 diabetes, even after allowing for sugar, fat and salt[1]. The highest third of ultra-processed eaters had a 17% higher heart-disease risk than the lowest third[1].

It is observational, so it cannot prove cause, the authors say[1]. But it arrives while the UK's nutrition advisers are weighing whether processing itself belongs in the guidance[1]. Evidence before rules: the right order.

SECURITY & ORDER · 2 MIN

310 drones, 272 stopped, 19 places hit, and the water came back by morning

Russia's overnight attack aimed at Ukraine's power grid again, six days before talks in Abu Dhabi. The defence that counts is the repair crew as much as the interceptor.

Russia launched 310 strike and decoy drones at Ukraine between 18:00 on Tuesday and Wednesday morning (Kyiv time), Ukraine's Air Force said[1]. Among them were 81 jet-powered Shaheds[1]. By 08:00 Kyiv time, air defences had shot down or neutralised 272, including 64 of the jet-powered ones[1]. Drones still struck 19 locations, and debris fell at 15 more[1]. Desk arithmetic: 272 of 310 is about 88%; 38 got through or went unaccounted for, and 17 of those were jet-powered.

The targets were the grid. Energy sites were hit in Zhytomyr, Ternopil and around Rivne; most of Kovel lost electricity; two men were injured at an industrial site in Dnipro[1]. By morning the energy ministry reported people without power in Vinnytsia, Zhytomyr, Zaporizhzhia, Kirovohrad, Kharkiv and Kherson oblasts, with emergency blackouts across Kyiv and the surrounding region for a second day[2]. Ukraine's nuclear plants are running at reduced capacity until the damaged networks are repaired, and DTEK said on Tuesday that a massive missile and drone barrage had stopped generation at three of its thermal plants[2].

Then the dull machinery started. Kyiv's water, lost on Tuesday, was partly restored on Wednesday morning[2]. Kovel's water utility switched to backup power and published hours when taps would run[1]. Zhytomyr announced warming points, where residents can heat up, charge phones and get online, would open at 09:00 if power was not back[1]. "Repair crews are working around the clock," the ministry said[2].

The air-defence arithmetic is the strained part. Zelenskyy said in Berlin on Tuesday that Ukraine has "great difficulties in air defence", citing a major shortage of PAC-2, PAC-3 and IRIS-T missiles, bne IntelliNews reports[3]. He wants an energy ceasefire on both sides as a first aim for the Abu Dhabi talks on 10–11 November[3].

For you, the lesson is not drama but logistics. …

Continue in reading view →

WHAT TO WATCH

- The Ukraine–US–Russia talks in Abu Dhabi on 10–11 November, where Zelenskyy wants an energy ceasefire on both sides.
- The coalition of the willing in Berlin on 19 November, where Merz said he would try to clear interceptor supply problems.

DESK COMMENT

Interceptors buy the night. Linemen buy the morning.

SECURITY & ORDER · SHORT ITEM · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

Five confirmed attacks in three days, and four 'destroyed' tankers nobody can find

In the Strait of Hormuz, the confirmed list and the claimed list are not the same list. Read the one with times and coordinates.

At 20:00 CET on Tuesday, a 23-year-old supertanker was hit in its engine room by two unknown projectiles 14 nautical miles north-east of Limah, in Omani waters[1]. The maritime security firm Vanguard Tech named it as the Barbados-flagged VLCC Grit[1]. No crew were hurt; the damage was not yet known[1]. The ship appears on the blacklist kept by Iran's Persian Gulf Strait Authority[1].

Continue in reading view →

SECURITY & ORDER · BRIEF · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

2,800 troops, 11 nations, 9 to 22 November: rehearsing for the day after

Britain and France will lead Exercise Koalicja in Poland from 9 to 22 November, the first major exercise of the Multinational Force Ukraine, the military arm of the coalition of the willing[1]. About 2,800 troops from 11 nations take part: Belgium, Estonia, France, Germany, Lithuania, the Netherlands, Poland, Spain, Sweden, Türkiye and the UK, which sends 300 personnel, RAF Typhoons and a Voyager tanker[1]. The force would move into Ukraine only once fighting has stopped and at Kyiv's request, and it "would not carry out peacekeeping or ceasefire-monitoring duties", the UK Ministry of Defence says[1]. What it rehearses is dull and essential: moving, protecting and supplying troops, and, from Istanbul, clearing mines so merchant ships can return to Ukraine's ports[1]. Peace, when it comes, will need lorries, fuel and minesweepers on the first morning.

CLIMATE & WEATHER · 2 MIN

Red from the Sarrabus to Gallura, yellow from Hérault to Var, and schools shut a day ahead

A slow Mediterranean storm is settling over Sardinia and the French coast. The most useful thing about Wednesday was how early the paperwork arrived.

Sardinia's civil protection has issued a red alert, its highest level of hydrogeological risk, for the east of the island, from the Sarrabus through Ogliastra and the Baronia to Gallura[1,2]. It runs until 23:59 on Thursday 5 November; the rest of the island is on yellow[1]. The regional outlook quoted by L'Unione Sarda expects scattered strong thunderstorms between Ogliastra and the Baronie, with rainfall totals "locally up to very high" and gale-force gusts in the storms[2].

What happened next is the part worth noticing. By Wednesday, a day ahead, the mayors of Olbia and Nuoro had signed orders closing schools for Thursday[1]. Olbia also shut public offices that receive visitors, keeping minimum services, plus its cemeteries, its urban park and its sports grounds[1]. Nuoro closed schools of every kind, university sites, the library, museums, nurseries, parks and outdoor sports grounds[1]. Lanusei and Castiadas were heading the same way, and ANSA expected the list to grow[1]. In Cagliari, on yellow, the city published the streets where you should not park in case of flooding, and a car park to move to instead[2].

Across the water, the same pattern is a "durable Mediterranean episode", in Météo-France's words, on the coast from Hérault to Var[3]. Var, Gard, Bouches-du-Rhône, Hérault and both Corsican départements are on yellow for storms from Wednesday to Friday 6 November[3]. The forecaster expects the rain to intensify on Wednesday evening and continue all of Thursday, with large totals, especially on Corsica's eastern side, and says a higher rain-flood warning is possible[3].

None of these notices is dramatic, and that is the point. A colour code, a mayor's signature and a list of streets do not stop water. They move people out of its way before it arrives. If you are travelling to Sardinia, Corsica or the Provence coast on Thursday, check the local warnings before you set off, not on the road.

WHAT TO WATCH

- Whether Météo-France raises its rain-flood warning for the coast from Hérault to Var and for eastern Corsica, which it says is possible.
- Sardinia's red alert runs until 23:59 on Thursday 5 November.

DESK COMMENT

A school closed the day before a storm is not an overreaction. It is the forecast doing its job.

CLIMATE & WEATHER · SHORT ITEM · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

$835 back for every $1: the cheapest climate measure is a warning before the heat

Five days before COP31, the WHO puts prices on six unglamorous measures and finds they could prevent 1.6 million deaths a year.

The World Health Organization published a report on Wednesday that does something climate summits rarely do: it costs the boring things[1]. Its six measures are heat-health warning systems, climate-resilient drinking water, basic sanitation, hygiene and handwashing facilities, cleaner household fuels for cooking and heating, and efficient fossil-fuel pricing[1].

Scaled up worldwide, the WHO models, they could prevent 1.6 million deaths a year, about one in every 40 deaths, and avoid 16.7 billion tonnes of CO_2, equal to 31% of global annual emissions excluding land use[1]. Across five of the actions, every dollar invested is estimated to return $24[1].

The standout is the cheapest. …

Continue in reading view →

CLIMATE & WEATHER · BRIEF · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

Steel, aluminium, cement, fertiliser: Antalya's €5bn platform aims at the hard part

COP31 runs in Antalya from 9 to 20 November, with the leaders' summit on 11 and 12 November[1]. Most pre-summit news is about halls and visitor numbers: about 100,000 expected in the negotiating Blue Zone, 1.5 million in the public Green Zone[1].

The more useful item is a platform. Türkiye's industry ministry, the EBRD and the World Bank's IBRD and IFC will unveil an industrial decarbonisation investment platform for iron and steel, aluminium, cement and fertiliser[1]. It aims to back more than €5 billion of investment by 2030 and cut 20 million tonnes of CO_2-equivalent a year, starting with $250 million from the Climate Investment Funds and €5.7 million from the EU[1]. The EIB, Asian Development Bank and Islamic Development Bank are due to sign up at the summit[1].

Speeches end on 20 November. Loan books keep running.

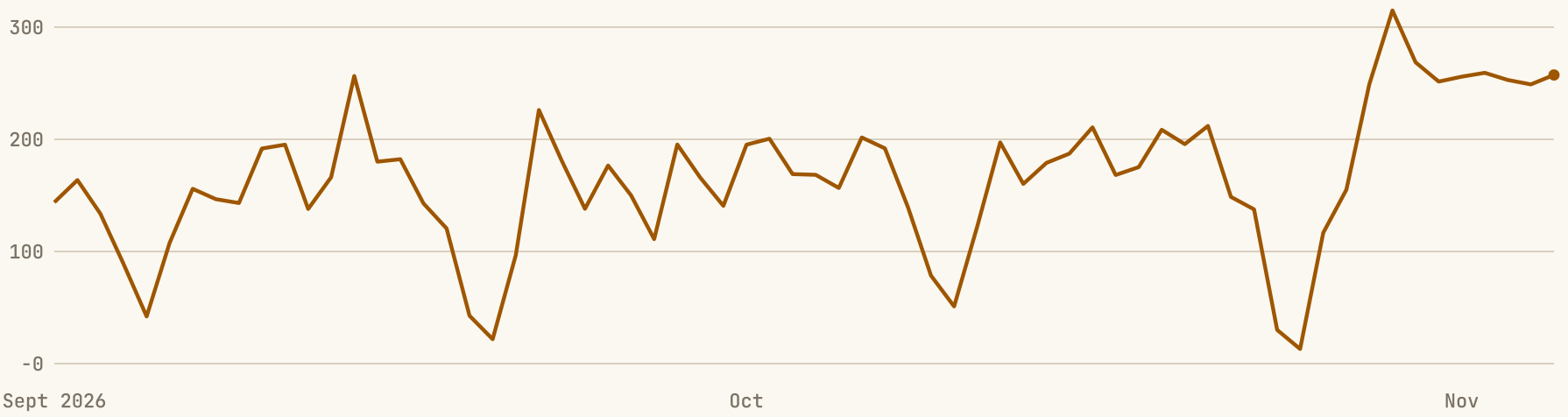
Charts and data

ENERGY · POWER

One day under €250, then Thursday clears €257.38

Germany/Luxembourg day-ahead electricity price, daily average by delivery day, € per MWh

Day-ahead DE-LU · All



▶ Data table (latest values)

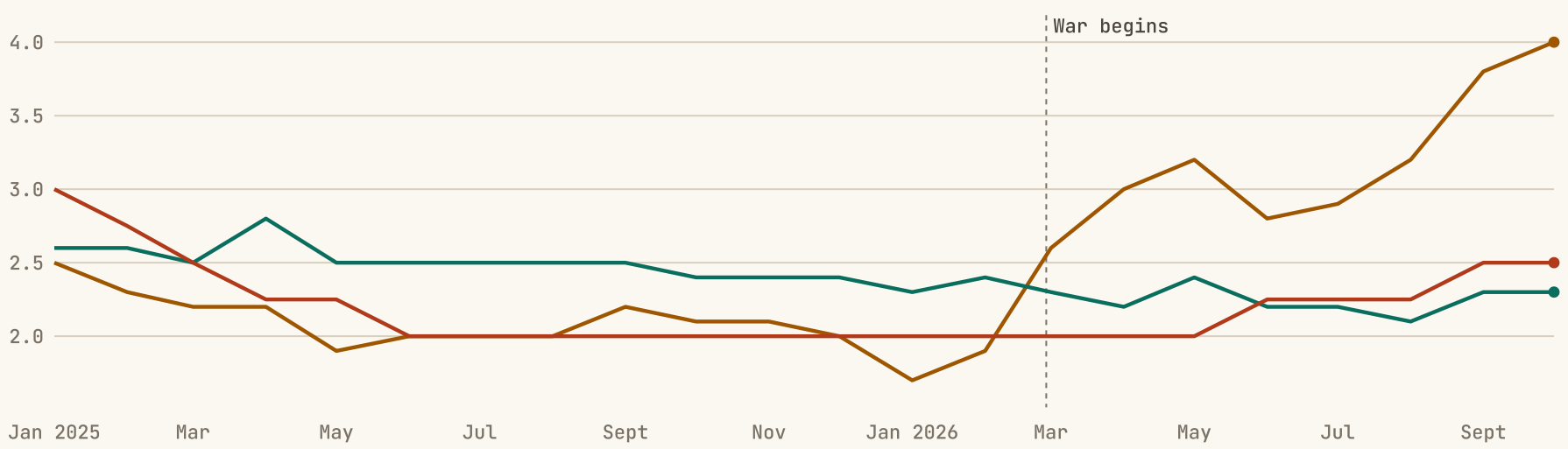
Source: Bundesnetzagentur | SMARD.de, day-ahead price DE-LU (filter 4169), delivery days 1 Sep to 5 Nov 2026, retrieved 4 Nov 2026 · CC BY 4.0 · CSV

MONEY · EURO AREA

4.0% for everything, still 2.3% without energy

Euro-area HICP inflation, annual change, %, monthly: all items and all items excluding energy · ECB deposit facility rate, %, month-end

HICP, all items · HICP excluding energy · ECB deposit rate · 3M · 6M · 1Y · All



▶ Data table (latest values)

Source: Eurostat prc_hicp_minr, EA, annual rate of change, all items (TOTAL) and excluding energy (TOT_X_NRG); October 2026 from the flash estimate of 4 Nov 2026 (estimated) (CC BY 4.0) · ECB, key ECB interest rates, deposit facility, month-end, unchanged on 29 Oct 2026 · retrieved 4 Nov 2026 · CSV

Latest values

SERIES	VALUE	DATE	CHART
Day-ahead DE-LU	257.38	5 Nov 2026	One day under €250, then Thursday clears €257.38
HICP, all items	4.0%	1 Oct 2026	4.0% for everything, still 2.3% without energy
HICP excluding energy	2.3%	1 Oct 2026	4.0% for everything, still 2.3% without energy
ECB deposit rate	2.5%	1 Oct 2026	4.0% for everything, still 2.3% without energy

Last data point of each series in the charts above, from the Inside Desk data archive. Sources under each chart.

Before you close the tab

THE DAY IN ONE SENTENCE

Heart failure is now found mostly in hospital beds, and the cheapest remedy for that is a doctor listening to a breathless patient's chest a few months sooner.

ONE THING YOU CAN DO THIS WEEK

If you heat with oil, look at the gauge on your tank this week and write the level and the date on a card taped next to it. Do it again in a fortnight. Two readings tell you how many litres a cold week really costs your house, and with deliveries running at about 26 days, that is the number you need before you call anyone.

A habit, not advice.

WHAT WENT RIGHT

People with bladder cancer who cannot have the standard chemotherapy have one more option that works. In the VOLGA trial of 695 people in 25 countries, adding two medicines, durvalumab and enfortumab vedotin, around bladder-removal surgery meant an estimated 78 in every 100 were alive two years later, against 69 in every 100 offered surgery without them [1]. The benefit came with more severe side effects, 71 in every 100 against 50, and it still needs regulatory approval before routine use [1]. The results were published in the New England Journal of Medicine and announced at the ESMO congress; AstraZeneca sponsored the study [1]. Nine more people in every hundred, counted carefully.

IN EUROS AT HOME

Heating oil cost a national average of €173 per 100 litres in Germany on Wednesday, against €92 at the same time last year, agrarheute reported; prices ranged from about €167 in Brandenburg, Berlin and Schleswig-Holstein to €177–179 in Hesse and Rhineland-Palatinate, and deliveries take about 26 days [2]. Desk arithmetic: a typical bridging order of 2,000 litres costs about €3,460 at today's average, against about €1,840 a year ago, roughly €1,620 more. Between the cheapest and dearest states, the same order differs by about €240 [2].

Desk arithmetic on reported national and state averages, before delivery surcharges. Nothing here is advice.

SMALL WORDS

Event-free survival

A way trials count how long patients live without something bad happening: the cancer growing or returning, death, or, in VOLGA, not getting the planned surgery while cancer remained [1]. It moves sooner than overall survival, which is why trials report it first; overall survival is the slower, firmer number [1].

1. Drug combination helps more people with bladder cancer live longer — Queen Mary University of London, 4 Nov 2026
2. Heizölpreise bleiben teuer – obwohl Ölpreise fallen: Was Heizöl im November kostet — agrarheute, 4 Nov 2026, 11:41 CET

Commentary for information only. Not investment, legal, tax, medical or political advice. Inside Desk is free and reader-supported. Every number is sourced in the piece it appears in.